



The hardest hit: Having featured in just two of Sunrisers Hyderabad's first 10 games this season, Washington Sundar has been starved of opportunities at a franchise keen on resetting the T20 template.

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seven specialist batters and then bring in a specialist sixth bowler by subbing out a batter in the bowling innings. It's vice versa for the team chasing — captains carry two team sheets to the toss.

"Eventually, cricket is played by 11 players, not 12 players. I am not a big fan of 'Impact Player'; you are taking so much from the game just for a little bit of entertainment. I can give you so many examples; guys like Washington Sundar and Shivam Dube are not getting to bowl. For us (the Indian team), it is not a good thing," Rohit Sharma, who will lead India at the T20 World Cup in less than a month, voiced his concern.

Washington, an economical

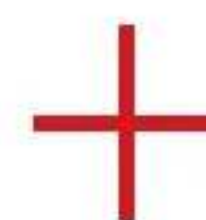
off-spinner and a handy batter lower down in the order, has been particularly hard-hit. Having featured in just two of Sunrisers Hyderabad's first 10 games this season, the 24-year-old has been starved of opportunities at a franchise keen on resetting the T20 template. On both occasions, Washington came on as Impact Player after Sunrisers' batting innings and could only bowl five overs across two matches.

For his teammate Abhishek Sharma, who has batted with abandon in the PowerPlay thanks to

the cushion provided by the Impact Player rule, the innovation has been a double-edged sword.

"Everybody knows that I can bowl. But because of this Impact Player rule, there is always an extra bowler. It is going to happen with all-rounders. It happened last year, and it is happening this year as well," Abhishek, who has bowled just three overs so far, said.

Dube, whose power-hitting in the middle overs for Chennai Super Kings earned him a spot in India's T20 World Cup squad, has been



The onset of the Impact Player rule has also diminished the role of part-timers, such as Deepak Hooda and Riyan Parag, and has left in its wake a legion of unidimensional strongmen.